

Agapito Emanuele Santangelo

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Applied economist working at the intersection of **causal inference** and **digital trace data** for the evaluation of public policies, with active research lines on digital transformation, institutional quality, and innovation.

Methods: Causal inference (*generalized and staggered Difference-in-Differences*, *panel data econometrics*); machine learning and Natural Language Processing (NLP) (*text mining*, *embeddings*, *supervised classification*); large-scale digital trace data (*web scraping*, *social media*, *high-frequency data*) integrated with administrative data.

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics (XXXVIII Cycle), Doctor Europaeus mention – *University of Molise* Nov 2022 – Apr 2026

Thesis: *Shocks, Public Policies, and Technological Progress: Four Essays on the Drivers of Innovation.*

Visiting PhD Researcher at Universitat Politècnica de València (UPV), Spain, Jan–Jul 2024 (*host: Prof. Josep Domenech*).

Supervisor: Prof. Giuliano Resce

MSc in Management, Entrepreneurship & Innovation, summa cum laude – *University of Molise* Sep 2017 – Apr 2019

Thesis: *La relazione tra vincoli finanziari e innovazione: un'analisi su un campione di imprese* (The relationship between financial constraints and innovation: an analysis of a sample of firms).

Supervisor: Prof. Filomena Pietrovito

PUBLICATIONS

- Carneiro, B., Resce, G., Caravaggio, N., **Santangelo, A. E.**, Ruscica, G., ... & Coffey, K. (2025). *Text mining and machine learning reveal global determinants of food insecurity*. **Scientific Reports**, 15(1), 36709. [\[Link\]](#)
- Pastore, L., Corvo, L., **Santangelo, A. E.**, Resce, G., & Lelo, A. (2025). *Measuring sustainability impacts through SROI: a case study of the Italian glass industry's contribution to the SDGs*. **Accounting, Auditing & Accountability Journal**, 38(5), 1483–1498. [\[Link\]](#)
- Santangelo, A. E.** (2023). *The relationship between financial constraints and innovation, with a supportive analysis on a sample of firms*. **Journal of Academic Research in Economics**, 15(3), 523–544. [\[Link\]](#)
- Pietrovito, F., & **Santangelo, A. E.** (2022). *Divario Nord-Sud: un focus sul Molise*. **GLOCALE**, 18(19). [\[Link\]](#)

WORKING PAPERS

- Caravaggio, N., Resce, G., & **Santangelo, A. E.** (2025). *EU Cohesion Policy and Digital Public Services (Job Market Paper)*. ESDP No. 25100, University of Molise. [\[Link\]](#)
Under review, *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*.
- Caravaggio, N., Resce, G., & **Santangelo, A. E.** (2026). *Digital Investment and the Evolution of Government Services*. ESDP No. 26104, University of Molise. [\[Link\]](#)
Under review, *Structural Change and Economic Dynamics*.
- Bergantino, A. S., Gabrielli, L., Resce, G., & **Santangelo, A. E.** (2026). *Competition Without Punctuality Gains: Evidence from Italian High-Speed Rail*. SSRN Working Paper. [\[Link\]](#)
Under review, *Transportation Research Part A: Policy and Practice*.
- Pietrovito, F., Rancan, A., Resce, G., & **Santangelo, A. E.** (2026). *Do Fiscal Constraints Affect Health Inequality Research? A Bibliometric Perspective*. ESDP No. 26102, University of Molise. [\[Link\]](#)

REFEREED CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

- Cebrián Cerdá, E., **Santangelo, A. E.**, & Domenech, J. (2025). *Are people losing interest in environmental issues? Insights from Google Trends*. CARMA 2025, Rome, 2–4 July 2025. [\[Link\]](#)
- Nigro, I., **Santangelo, A. E.**, & Modina, M. (2025). *Detecting potential fake innovators using web scraping: the case for Italian startup*. CARMA 2025, Rome, 2–4 July 2025. [\[Link\]](#)
- Caravaggio, N., Di Renzo, G., Fanelli, L., Resce, G., & **Santangelo, A. E.** (2024). *In What is Europe Investing? A Text Mining Approach on Cohesion Projects*. CARMA 2024, Valencia, 26–28 June 2024. [\[Link\]](#)
- Carneiro, B., Resce, G., Tucci, G., Ruscica, G., Caravaggio, N., Fanelli, L., **Santangelo, A. E.**, & Cruciata, P. (2024). *A multi-platform framework for nowcasting social phenomena: a case study for food insecurity*. CARMA 2024, Valencia, 26–28 June 2024. [\[Link\]](#)

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Research Assistant** – *Regione Lazio* – Regional Statistical System for Policy Support May 2025 – Jul 2026
Evaluation of the economic sustainability of Lazio municipalities.
Supervisor: Prof. Cecilia Tomassini
- Data Analysis Strategist** – *Instant Analytics* Sep 2024 – Present
Advanced analytics to inform strategic decisions and policy recommendations.
Principal Investigator: Prof. Giuliano Resce
- Research Assistant** – **PRIN Project** – *University of Molise* May 2024 – May 2025
Evaluation of the Italian healthcare system in the post-pandemic context: efficiency, equity, territorial disparities.
Supervisor: Prof. Giuliano Resce
- Research Assistant** – **Food Insecurity Trends Project** – *University of Molise* Aug 2023 – May 2024
Project for the International Center for Tropical Agriculture (CIAT): data-driven analysis of food insecurity drivers and hazards; results published in *Scientific Reports* (2025).
Supervisor: Prof. Giuliano Resce
- Junior Expert in Policy Evaluation** – *Eutalia S.p.A.* Apr 2023 – Dec 2023
Evaluation plan and impact evaluation of *PON Research and Innovation 2014–2020*.
Coordinator: Prof. Francesco Prota

TEACHING

- Teaching Assistant** – *University of Molise* 2022 – Present
Since 2022: Monetary and Financial Economics and Policy; Macroeconomics; Industrial Economics and Game Theory; Microeconomics; Cost-Benefit Analysis; Economic Policy.
Since 2025: Applied Health Economics; Public Economics.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS & WORKSHOPS

- **CARMA 2026** – 8th Int. Conf. on Advanced Research Methods and Analytics, Universitat Politècnica de València, 1–3 July 2026. *Presenter.*
- **AISRe 2026** – XLVII Annual Scientific Conference of the *Italian Regional Science Association* (RSAI Italian Section), Università di Firenze, 24–26 June 2026. *Presenter.*
- **Understanding and Addressing Digital Inequalities** – Annual Scientific Conference on Digital Democracy, *Centre for a Digital Society, European University Institute (EUI)*, Florence, 20–21 November 2025. *Presenter.*
- **SIE 2025** – 66th Annual Scientific Meeting of the *Italian Economic Association (Società Italiana di Economia)*, Università di Napoli Parthenope, 23–25 October 2025. *Presenter.*
- **AISRe 2025** – XLVI Annual Scientific Conference of the *Italian Regional Science Association* (RSAI Italian Section), Università “G. d’Annunzio” Chieti-Pescara, 10–12 September 2025. *Presenter.*
- **CARMA 2025** – 7th Int. Conf. on Advanced Research Methods and Analytics, Rome, 2–4 July 2025. *Presenter.*
- **CARMA 2024** – 6th Int. Conf. on Advanced Research Methods and Analytics, Valencia, 26–28 June 2024. *Presenter.*

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- Referee for:** The Annals of Regional Science · Italian Economic Journal · Research in International Business and Finance · PLOS ONE · Journal of Infrastructure, Policy and Development.
- Conference organization:** CARMA 2025 (Rome) · CARMA 2024 (Valencia) · HEAd’24 – 10th Int. Conf. on Higher Education Advances.

POLICY REPORTS & DISSEMINATION

- *PON Research and Innovation 2014–2020 – Final Evaluation Report*. [\[Link\]](#)
- *Eticaeconomia: In cosa investe l’Unione Europea? Un’analisi di Text Mining sui progetti di coesione*. [\[Link\]](#)
- *Eticaeconomia: Il PNRR nella comunicazione istituzionale dei comuni*. [\[Link\]](#)

ADVANCED TRAINING

- *SoBigData Academy Camp – Data Science, Machine Learning, Data Ethics and Social Data Analysis* (SoBigData Research Infrastructure, 2026).
- *LSE Summer School – Advanced Econometrics* (Dr. M. Schafgans, Dr. M. Gmeiner, 2025) and *Applied Econometrics and Big Data* (Prof. T. Komarova, Dr. M. Schafgans, 2025).
- *6th Summer School in Advanced Economics – Modern Causal Inference* (Prof. J. M. Wooldridge, Prof. P. Sant’Anna; University of Ioannina, Spetses, 2025).
- *SIde – Introductory Econometrics* (Prof. G. Calzolari, 2024) and *Panel Data Econometrics* (Prof. M. E. Bontempi, Prof. R. Golinelli, Dr. I. Mammi, 2024).
- *Evaluation of Development Policies* (Prof. P. Montalbano, Prof. F. C. Rosati, Prof. C. Pietrobelli, 2023).
- *Harvard Online Professional Certificate in Data Science* (2023).

SKILLS, LANGUAGES & AWARDS

Programming & tools: R, Stata, Python, L^AT_EX.

Languages: Italian (native), English (C1), Spanish (B1).

Awards: *America Giovani* Prize, Fondazione Italia USA – top 1,000 Italian graduates for academic excellence (2019).

MEMBERSHIPS

Società Italiana di Economia (SIE) · Associazione Italiana di Scienze Regionali (AISRe).